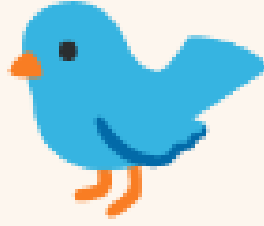


ARAB FINGERS STORIES



The Clever Crow

الْغُرَابُ الذَّكِي

من ٤ إلى ٨ سنوات · Ages 4–8

A thirsty crow finds a pitcher with just a little water at the bottom. His beak cannot reach it — but his mind can. A timeless fable, retold here in simple, fully vocalised Arabic.



فِي يَوْمٍ حَارٍّ، كَانَ غُرَابٌ عَطْشَانٌ.

fii yawmin Haarrin, kaana ghuraabun 'aTshaan.

On a hot day, there was a thirsty crow.



طَارَ فَوْقَ الْحُقُولِ حَتَّى رَأَى إِبْرِيْقًا فِيهِ
مَاءٌ.

Taara fawqa-l-Huquuli Hatta ra'aa ibriiqan fihi maa'.

He flew over the fields until he saw a pitcher with water in it.



اُقْتَرَبَ مِنَ الْإِبْرِيقِ، لَكِنَّ الْمَاءَ فِي
أَسْفَلِهِ!

iqtaraba mina-l-ibriqi, laakinna-l-maa'a fii asfalih!

He came close to the pitcher — but the water was at the very
bottom!



حَاوَلَ أَنْ يَصِلَ بِمِنْقَارِهِ، فَلَمْ يَسْتَطِعْ.

Haawala an yaSila biminaaarih, fa lam yastaTi'.

He tried to reach it with his beak, but he could not.



فَكَرَّ الْغُرَابُ وَفَكَرَّ... ثُمَّ رَأَى الْحَصَى
عَلَى الْأَرْضِ!

fakkara-l-ghuraabu wa fakkara... thumma ra'a-l-Hasaa 'ala-l-arD!

The crow thought and thought... then he saw the pebbles on the ground!



حَمَلَ حَصَاةً وَأَلْقَاهَا فِي الْإِبْرِيْقِ، ثُمَّ
أُخْرَى وَأُخْرَى.

Hamala Hasaatan wa alqaahaa fi-l-ibriiqi, thumma ukhraa wa ukhraa.

He picked up a pebble and dropped it into the pitcher, then
another and another.



ارْتَفَعَ الْمَاءُ قَلِيلًا قَلِيلًا حَتَّى بَلَغَ فَمَ
الْإِبْرِيقِ.

irtafa'a-l-maa'u qaliilan qaliilan Hatta balagha fama-l-ibriiq.

The water rose little by little, until it reached the mouth of the
pitcher.



شَرِبَ الْغُرَابُ وَاسْتَرَاخَ، ثُمَّ طَارَ سَعِيداً.

shariba-l-ghuraabu w-staraaHa, thumma Taara sa'iid.

The crow drank, rested, and flew away happy.

THE LESSON · الْعِبْرَة

Thinking solves what force cannot.

التَّفْكِيرُ يَحُلُّ مَا لَا تَحُلُّهُ الْقُوَّةُ.

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